CEBUANO PHOTOGRAPHER

RETRATISTA

MIDTERM: FEATURE AN ARTIST 9 | GR 13 GE-ART

LANCE CHRISTIAN GABRIEL

Featuring Lance's Art works in Photography and Cinematography

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CINEPANALO FILM AWARDEE

Featuring a film that earned three awards at the 2024 Puregold Cinepanalo Film Festival.

SLIZZ PRODUCTIONS

LANCE CHRISTIAN GABRIEL



The magazine is a presentation of the life and works of a local Cebuano film-maker, Lance Christian Gabriel. Lance is 21 years old college student of the University of San Carlos and is currently studying Bachelor of Fine Arts Major in Cinema in his 3rd year. The magazine exhibits life, an overview of the artist's form of artwork, techniques used, awards, recognition, and achievements received as a local Cebuano artist.



To be qualified as an artist one must engage in creative expression, skill enhancement, originality, purposefulness, consistency, and influence through their medium, showcasing dedication, unique viewpoints, and messages, while questioning conventions and enhancing cultural experiences.

Lance has gained extensive experience and plans to create his own production after graduation. He aims to work in sustainable film industries and pursue a master's degree in business after obtaining his bachelor's degree. He aims to be a successful and financially stable filmmaker, aiming to leave a lasting impact through films.





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ABOUT PHYSICAL WORK



Film-making is collaborative. As such, a film undergoes several processes before it is completed and normally involves a crew of people. Before everything, ideas are first brainstormed and formulated. According to Lance, these ideas usually come from the experiences of the filmmakers. These experiences could be something passionate, tragic, or unique — resulting in a film that represents him, his community, or his culture. Once these ideas have been formulated, they are pitched to a producer (who funds the film), and then he finds a team that will help in the completion of the project.

In making a screenplay, he integrates different stories. The writers he works with bring with them stories from their own regions, cultures, and communities, and these stories are integrated into the film. The same is true for his photoshoots, as he takes inspiration from those around him as well. At times when he is actively looking for motivation, Lance likes to take a walk –especially around Cebu I.T. Park – and observe people. As such, most of what he produces is in the context of Filipino daily life and cultures, and the films are usually in the Filipino language.

Just recently, Lance participated in a short film titled **"Tiil ni Lola."** Directed by Reutsche Colle Lima, the film follows four siblings and their breakthrough into music. It showcases Filipino values like familial ties and perseverance. The film bagged three awards (Best Editing, Best Original Song for "Balik", and 2nd Place for Responsableng Paglikha) at the 2024 Puregold Cinepanalo Film Festival, alongside nine other nominations for the film and crew.

In addition to traditional Filipino values, Lance is a political filmmaker. He wants to dabble in films that are based on real-world problems, especially in his own community, stating that he wants to seek the truth and show it via film.

One of the biggest challenges he faces in this field is the cost. Given the nature of film-making, it is quite expensive and time-consuming, so results are not made in just a few days. It is also very expensive with little return investment since they spend a lot already on cameras and equipment, then the additional cost of actually producing a film. To alleviate this, Lance takes on corporate shoots and commissions. He uses the money he gains from those commissions to improve his equipment or pay back what he spent, especially on projects where he isn't paid it cash but, rather, through exchange deals. Lance shared that he is currently working on projects for Profoods corporation and JPark, among others.



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ABOUT THE INNER EXPERIENCE

Lance wasn't always geared toward filmmaking, but he dabbled in filming, editing, and directing in past projects. His entry into the art world came in the form of cosplay – a form of performance art where someone wears costumes and accessories (some of these being D.I.Y.-ed) to represent a fictional character – as he was an active cosplayer in high school.



It was in his first semester of college that the passion for to be a filmmaker clicked for him. For a midterm project, they had to make a short piece about their "center" – something from the core of their being. He made one about a girl who was being bullied for cosplaying, an experience Lance resonated with. In the short film, the girl was being called a weirdo and an outcast – looked down upon by her peers for her hobby. The piece went viral in the cosplay community as more people resonated with it. It was from there that it clicked for him: he wanted to express himself through film and, with his films, produce something that people can relate to.

His passion for film, and eventually photography, only kept growing. To Lance, this career path is not only fun and sustainable but also something he can see himself doing in the future and not getting tired of, as he feels ecstatic every time he works on a piece.

Every time he works, he thinks about how the audience would feel when they view the work. He talks about his motivations, and how a strong support system and drive to improve is crucial in this field. The industry is harsh, so surrounding himself with people who can stand with him, especially in college, sets a very good precedent for his career.

Lance likes to watch films, be it his own or from others, to motivate and inspire himself to continue pursuing this field. He is particularly fond of films that depict historical events or period films - contributing to his intent to be a political filmmaker.

"Art is there to make you uncomfortable for it is not held by any boundaries. People can be offended [and] hurt, but its purpose is to make you feel something."

When asked about the meaning of art, he said "Art is there to make you feel something." Art can be a tool to make people aware of things. It is meant to move people, to make them feel things, especially the Filipino people. Being primarily conservative people, Filipinos are not as accepting of art which makes them uncomfortable. However, to Lance, there is no point in art if it does not make you feel.

"At the start, I was hesitant because I was inexperienced but now I [have] improved in dealing with [clients]."

Although Lance likes being a creative filmmaker, wanting to join film festivals and meet professional filmmakers, he is also doing corporate shoots. With the field being inherently expensive, it is important that he also thinks practically. He's had to practice resourcefulness when the equipment he needs is not accessible. Corporate shoots also help him broaden his connections, something important in the Philippine film industry. When he first started taking in commissions, Lance was quite hesitant due to inexperience, but constant practice and exposure helped him gain confidence and improve how he dealt with clients.

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STUDENT INSIGHT



The artist loves creating stories through videos and films since he was a little child, it has greatly influenced his path into filmmaking. His passion for telling stories and illustrating moments shows how deeply he is connected to the film production. His long-term dedication to making films is shown by his desire to continue filmmaking as a career which motivated by both his enjoyment and sustainability in the art form.



His work includes a lot of Filipino culture and tradition since he makes an effort to bring together different stories, languages, and views into his films. His goal is to present Filipino culture through documentaries and narrative films that tackle current issues. The artist's creative process involves inspiration from personal experiences and showcasing ideas that resonate with him. He acknowledges the collaborative nature of filmmaking, highlighting the importance of teamwork and perseverance in bringing ideas to life.

His goals as a filmmaker are to promote justice and the truth while bringing attention to social issues. He believes that art may effectively raise awareness, especially in the context of the conservative Filipino culture.The artist is dedicated even though of financial difficulties, finding creative ways to fund his work through corporate shoots and skill. His talent and determination are shown in his recent achievements, which include nominations and prizes for his films. With that the artist is excited about upcoming projects and collaborations, including commercial shoots and film festival entries. He stays motivated by surrounding himself with supportive people, watching films for inspiration, and showcasing from his own experiences. His artistic path has been shaped by memorable experiences, such making a film on cosplay, which motivates him to keep making films that connect with viewers. In order to secure his financial future, he plans to pursue a master's degree in business in addition to becoming the owner of his production firm.

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OTHER ART WORKS









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